

Dance music

Dance has long been part of celebration. Originally improvised, it is now mostly for groups, pairs, or individuals. Group dance is based on ancient folk traditions, while pair dancing is a recent evolution developed from courtly dances of the 16th century onward.

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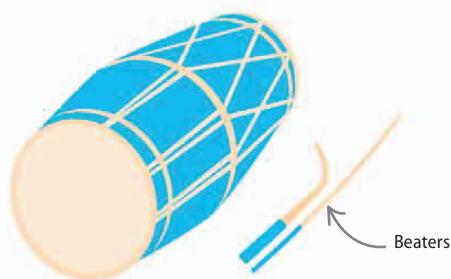
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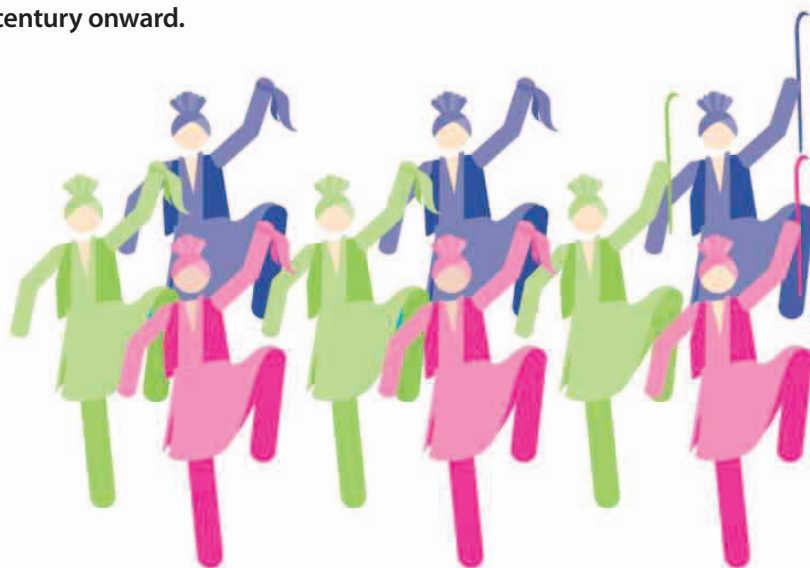
Bhangra

Bhangra originated in Punjab, India, as a harvest celebration, accompanied with singing and drumming. It is now fused with Western music to produce a highly energetic form of celebratory dance and song for festivities and weddings.



△ Dhol

The large, loud dhol drum is played with cane beaters in bhangra. Sometimes European instruments, such as electric guitars, provide simple harmony.



△ Bhangra dance

Bhangra is performed in circles or lines, using swords or sticks. The songs are based on traditional poems, “boli,” usually about love and relationships.

Irish and Scottish dance

Celtic countries, particularly Scotland and Ireland, have a long history of traditional dance tunes and songs. Among the most popular dances are reels and hornpipes, which use similar steps. The music is usually quick, with two or four beats in a measure, simple harmonies, and folk-like melodies, which are often based on modes rather than conventional scales.

▽ Reel

“St Kilda Wedding” is a traditional Scottish reel which is tune, often played on a fiddle. It features a characteristic “snap,” or quick syncopation.



◁ Jig

The jig is usually in 6/8 and danced with jumping steps. The tune may be played in unison by fiddles, whistles, Uilleann (Irish) pipes, and the Irish bodhran drum.